Answer key

SAT Practice Test 2, Reading and Writing

Module 1

NO.	ANSWER	SKILL
1	C	Words in context
2	A	Words in context
3	D	Words in context
4	B	Words in context
5	C	Text structure and purpose
6	D	Text structure and purpose
7	C	Central ideas and details
8	D	Central ideas and details
9	A	Command of evidence: quantitative
10	A	Command of evidence: quantitative
11	D	Command of evidence: textual
12	C	Command of evidence: textual
13	A	Inferences
14	B	Inferences
15	C	Form, structure, and sense
16	C	Boundaries
17	A	Form, structure, and sense
18	B	Boundaries
19	D	Form, structure, and sense
20	D	Boundaries
21	B	Form, structure, and sense
22	A	Transitions
23	A	Transitions
24	B	Transitions
25	D	Rhetorical synthesis
26	C	Rhetorical synthesis
27	A	Rhetorical synthesis

Module 2

NO.	ANSWER	SKILL
1	A	Words in context
2	D	Words in context
3	B	Words in context
4	C	Words in context
5	C	Text structure and purpose
6	D	Text structure and purpose
7	D	Cross-text connections
8	B	Central ideas and details
9	A	Central ideas and details
10	A	Command of evidence: quantitative
11	C	Command of evidence: quantitative
12	D	Command of evidence: textual
13	B	Command of evidence: textual
14	C	Inferences
15	B	Inferences
16	B	Form, structure, and sense
17	C	Boundaries
18	A	Form, structure, and sense
19	D	Boundaries
20	B	Boundaries
21	D	Form, structure, and sense
22	A	Transitions
23	A	Transitions
24	C	Transitions
25	D	Rhetorical synthesis
26	B	Rhetorical synthesis
27	A	Rhetorical synthesis

Answer key

SAT Practice Test 2, Math

Module 1

NO.	ANSWER	SKILL
1	**B**	Percentages
2	**D**	Data analysis
3	**A**	Linear equations
4	**C**	Systems of equations
5	**C**	Functions
6	**A**	Nonlinear expressions
7	**B**	Triangles
8	**C**	Probability
9	**C**	Scatterplots
10	**B**	Inequalities
11	**D**	Functions
12	**A**	Exponential functions
13	**C**	Linear functions
14	**B**	Percent change
15	**A**	Volume
16	**D**	Right triangles
17	**16**	Systems of equations
18	**4**	Quadratics
19	**11**	Linear equations
20	**9**	Functions
21	**8**	Right triangles
22	**56**	Area

Module 2

NO.	ANSWER	SKILL
1	**A**	Exponential functions
2	**C**	Quadratics
3	**D**	Percentages
4	**B**	Volume
5	**C**	Functions
6	**A**	Statistics
7	**D**	Probability
8	**B**	Surface area
9	**A**	Circles
10	**B**	Equivalent expressions
11	**D**	Trigonometry
12	**C**	Exponential equations
13	**A**	Exponential functions
14	**B**	Linear functions in context
15	**D**	Absolute value
16	**C**	Ratios and rates
17	**10**	Linear equations
18	**8**	Circles in the plane
19	**154**	Quadratics
20	**15**	Percentages
21	**14**	Quadratics
22	**-3**	Systems with nonlinear equations

Score yourself. Count the questions you got right in each module.

Reading and Writing, Module 1: ___ of 27

Module 2: ___ of 27

Math, Module 1: ___ of 22

Module 2: ___ of 22

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 2, Reading and Writing, Module 1

Questions 1 to 14

1 **Choice C** Words in context

Restricting the movement of firewood is a way of keeping the beetle from spreading, so limit fits. Encourage and celebrate run against the officials' aim, and document does not describe a restriction.

2 **Choice A** Words in context

The colon explains that the menu has only five dishes, so limited is the logical word. Sprawling is the opposite, and the passage says nothing about indifference or age.

3 **Choice D** Words in context

She repeats herself to avoid disappointing buyers, which shows a reluctance to take risks that complacent captures. Curious would lead her to experiment, and nothing suggests generosity or impatience.

4 **Choice B** Words in context

Dense shade that blocks seedlings suggests very large, dominant trees, and imposing conveys that. Delicate and unremarkable would not cast such shade.

5 **Choice C** Text structure and purpose

The underlined sentence says what the angle and duration of the dance mean, which explains how the dance carries information. It does not question bee communication or compare other insects.

6 **Choice D** Text structure and purpose

Lucía sets everything back where it was and cannot turn the calendar page, which shows her reluctance to disturb her aunt's life. She is careful, not careless, and the text does not explain the tidiness or suggest haste.

7 **Choice C** Central ideas and details

The text says the harvests are modest and that the real yield is social. It denies that the gardens could feed a neighbourhood and says nothing about difficulty or about most residents.

8 **Choice D** Central ideas and details

The text says the viaduct's failure is what she is remembered for, but that a contractor swapped her steel for a cheaper alloy. Nothing is said about destroyed notebooks, dismissing vibration, or being first to use steel.

9 **Choice A** Command of evidence: quantitative

The claim compares the share preferring loose fruit in the older and younger groups, which the first choice does. The next uses the pre-packed share, and the last mixes the two measures, so neither compares the same preference.

10 **Choice A** Command of evidence: quantitative

A recovery after closure means citing the low in 2020 and the later rise, and the first choice does this with figures. The others mix up the years or leave out the low point.

11 **Choice D** Command of evidence: textual

The sparseness of the later music is shown by the work asking the orchestra to play almost nothing. The first quotation describes the early dense style, and the others are either not about sparseness or describe its effect.

12 **Choice C** Command of evidence: textual

Pages folded and stitched around the cover show the fragment was used to bind the ledger. The language, the contents of the ledger and other holdings do not address how the fragment was used.

13 **Choice A** Inferences

Seeds that germinate in response to smoke are adapted to take advantage of conditions after fires. The text does not say they cannot grow elsewhere, and it contradicts the other choices.

14 **Choice B** Inferences

The researcher notes the cause might run the other way, so the survey alone cannot show that reading builds vocabulary. It does not show harm, claim that weak readers never read, or restrict the findings to one university.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 2, Reading and Writing, Module 1

Questions 15 to 27

15 **Choice C** Form, structure, and sense

The adverbial phrase next week requires the future, and the plural subject students takes will present. The other forms are singular or past.

16 **Choice C** Boundaries

The three items form a parallel list of plural nouns, so textiles is correct. The other choices break the parallel structure.

17 **Choice A** Form, structure, and sense

The opening phrase must modify the person who did the studying, so Dr. Kim must be the subject that follows the comma. The other choices attach the phrase to findings, the meeting or a pronoun, creating a dangling modifier.

18 **Choice B** Boundaries

The relative clause which took nearly four years to build is nonessential and is closed by a comma before the main verb. A semicolon, colon or full stop would leave the main clause without a subject.

19 **Choice D** Form, structure, and sense

The subject each is singular, so the verb is receives. The other choices are plural or ungrammatical.

20 **Choice D** Boundaries

The semicolon joins two independent clauses, and the second is a result of the first, so as a result is correct.

21 **Choice B** Form, structure, and sense

The second clause gives the reason the discovery was important, so because is the logical conjunction.

22 **Choice A** Transitions

The botanical classification contrasts with the culinary one, so however is the right transition.

23 **Choice A** Transitions

The fall in commuting times confirms what was expected, so Indeed is the logical transition.

24 **Choice B** Transitions

The sentence corrects the earlier belief with a fact, so In fact is the best transition. Likewise suggests similarity, and the others do not fit.

25 **Choice D** Rhetorical synthesis

To explain what the building is for, the choice must state its function, and only the first mentions tracking variable stars. The others give its history, visiting hours or an installation date.

26 **Choice C** Rhetorical synthesis

A comparison needs details about both rivers on the same points, which the first choice gives. The others describe one river or the shared sea.

27 **Choice A** Rhetorical synthesis

Age is conveyed by the date of around 1190, which only the first choice gives. The others describe the codex's contents, material or restoration.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 2, Reading and Writing, Module 2

Questions 1 to 14

1 **Choice A** **Words in context**

She said enough to be friendly but nothing binding, so her remarks were carefully measured. Calibrated fits. Impulsive and defiant contradict the care described, and garbled would mean confused.

2 **Choice D** **Words in context**

The sentence describes a disease once confined to the tropics, so scourge, meaning a source of affliction, is the fitting noun. Haven and remedy suggest benefit, and relic implies something from the past.

3 **Choice B** **Words in context**

Wording that lets both sides claim a win must be capable of several readings, which elastic suggests. Rigid and emphatic would leave little room for dispute.

4 **Choice C** **Words in context**

Far from signals that she was the opposite of resistant, and she actively sought criticism. Impervious means unable to be affected, which fits the contrast. Vulnerable and sensitive would not contrast with seeking criticism.

5 **Choice C** **Text structure and purpose**

The underlined sentence describes the slow accumulation of discrepancies, which shows that the revolution was gradual, contrary to the popular image of one decisive moment. It does not describe a single experiment, say the old model had no defenders, or introduce a theory to be evaluated.

6 **Choice D** **Text structure and purpose**

The sentence lists real hazards the speeches ignored, which supports Corliss's impression that the speakers lack knowledge of the sea. It does not mention a speech by him, claim the vessel is more dangerous, or say the harbour is now safe.

7 **Choice D** **Cross-text connections**

Text 2 notes the new styles began before photography spread, so the historian would say Text 1 mistakes cause for coincidence or acceleration. The historian says the camera made visible an existing interest, so does not deny all influence.

8 **Choice B** **Central ideas and details**

The text reports membraneless droplets that act as compartments, which means cells need less physical structure than thought. It says the picture is more crowded, not less, and oil is only an analogy.

9 **Choice A** **Central ideas and details**

The text argues that GDP counts all spending, including repair of damage, so it should not be read as welfare. It does not say GDP falls with repairs, or that economists have abandoned it.

10 **Choice A** **Command of evidence: quantitative**

At week 12 the graph shows 92 cm for the higher amount and 77 cm for the lower, a difference of 15 cm. The other choices change the size of the gap, swap the groups, or move the data to the wrong week.

11 **Choice C** **Command of evidence: quantitative**

Reliability concerns how little the time varies, so the correct choice compares the differences between rush hour and other times. One choice reports only rush hour times, one swaps the figures for the bus and car, and one reports the shortest time rather than the variation.

12 **Choice D** **Command of evidence: textual**

The claim is that a mistaken theory could still lead to effective remedies, and only the quotation saying the measures worked but not for the believed reason states this directly. The others describe the theory, the measures or one mechanism without making the point.

13 **Choice B** **Command of evidence: textual**

Forest birds raising their pitch after exposure to traffic noise shows that noise itself can produce the change, which supports the researcher's causal claim. The other choices say nothing about noise causing a pitch change.

14 **Choice C** **Inferences**

Narrow, winding streets inside walls contrasted with wider ones built once the threat lessened, which suggests the earlier layout reflected defensive needs. Speed and shared architects are not suggested, and the walls are connected to the layout.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 2, Reading and Writing, Module 2

Questions 15 to 27

15 **Choice B** Inferences

Dense cordgrass raised the surface in step with sea level while thin cover let the marsh drown, so restoring grass should help marshes survive. The text gives no support for sinking or for calm seas making grass unnecessary.

16 **Choice B** Form, structure, and sense

The relative pronoun is the subject of had spent and refers to people, so who is correct. Whom is the wrong case, and which and that they are not suitable.

17 **Choice C** Boundaries

The subject is the singular number, not the plural species, so has agrees. A number of would take a plural verb, but the number of takes a singular one.

18 **Choice A** Form, structure, and sense

The opening phrase compares Pryce with her contemporaries, so the subject that follows must be Pryce herself. The other choices make the countryside or her writing the thing being compared with people.

19 **Choice D** Boundaries

The items in this list already contain commas, so semicolons are used to separate them. Only the first choice separates the second and third items with a semicolon and the conjunction and.

20 **Choice B** Boundaries

The subject is the singular fraction, so the verb is is. The other choices do not agree or are not finite verbs.

21 **Choice D** Form, structure, and sense

After the negative adverb rarely, the auxiliary comes before the subject, so does an observer encounter is correct. The other choices fail to invert or fail to agree.

22 **Choice A** Transitions

The sentence introduces newer findings that qualify the long-standing recommendation, so More recently, is the correct transition.

23 **Choice A** Transitions

The poets' embrace of railways contrasts with the general suspicion, so Nevertheless is the logical transition.

24 **Choice C** Transitions

The short lifespan is a limit that contrasts with the animal's intelligence, so Yet is the correct transition.

25 **Choice D** Rhetorical synthesis

The goal is to show how a discovery changed what is known, so the choice must contrast the earlier count with the newer one, which the first does. The others give dates, a detail of the new figures, or a method without the change.

26 **Choice B** Rhetorical synthesis

The audience wants the key result and its limit, and only the first choice gives both the success rate and the false alarms. The others give the method, a call for trials, or the success rate alone.

27 **Choice A** Rhetorical synthesis

A contrast needs both approaches with their features, which the first choice supplies. The others name the methods without features, describe only one method, or give a single reason.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 2, Math, Module 1

Questions 1 to 11

1 **Choice B** **Percentages**

20% of 500 is 0.2 times 500, which is 100.

2 **Choice D** **Data analysis**

Team 5 has 25 and Team 1 has 15, and 25 minus 15 is 10.

3 **Choice A** **Linear equations**

Subtract 2x from both sides: 7x + 2 = 72. Then 7x = 70, so x = 10.

4 **Choice C** **Systems of equations**

Adding the equations gives 2x = 28, so x = 14.

5 **Choice C** **Functions**

Each step of 1 in x adds 6 to f(x), so the slope is 6. Then f(1) = 14 gives 6 + 8, so the intercept is 8.

6 **Choice A** **Nonlinear expressions**

Multiply the coefficients, 5 times 5 is 25, and add the exponents, 5 plus 6 is 11.

7 **Choice B** **Triangles**

The angles of a triangle add to 180°, so x + 2x + 6x = 9x = 180 and x = 20.

8 **Choice C** **Probability**

45 students travel that way and 18 of them are in Grade 10, so the probability is 18/45, which simplifies to 2/5. The fraction with 138 on the bottom uses every student.

9 **Choice C** **Scatterplots**

Substitute x = 6: 6(6) + 44 = 36 + 44 = 80.

10 **Choice B** **Inequalities**

The total is the 32 already joined plus 10 each week, and it must be at least 150, so 32 + 10w ≥ 150.

11 **Choice D** **Functions**

f(4) = 4(16) − 12 + 6 = 64 − 12 + 6 = 58.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 2, Math, Module 1

Questions 12 to 22

12 **Choice A** **Exponential functions**

Tripling every 6 hours means the number of triplings is t/6, so the population is 800 times 3 to the power t/6.

13 **Choice C** **Linear functions**

The slope is (28 − 13)/(6 − 3) = 5. Using (3, 13), 13 = 5(3) + b gives b = −2.

14 **Choice B** **Percent change**

The increase is 1,500, and dividing by the original 6,000 gives 0.25, which is 25%. Dividing by the new value would give a smaller percent.

15 **Choice A** **Volume**

The volume is $\pi r^2 h = \pi(36)(8) = 288\pi$.

16 **Choice D** **Right triangles**

$5^2 + 12^2 = 169$, so the hypotenuse is $\sqrt{169} = 13$.

17 **16** **Systems of equations**

Adding x + y = 22 and x − y = 10 gives 2x = 32, so the larger number is 16.

18 **4** **Quadratics**

The equation factors as (x − 4)(x + 3) = 0, so the solutions are 4 and −3. The positive one is 4.

19 **11** **Linear equations**

Expanding gives 4x − 8 = 8x − 52. Collecting terms gives −4x = −44, so x = 11.

20 **9** **Functions**

8a − 6 = 66 gives 8a = 72, so a = 9.

21 **8** **Right triangles**

By the Pythagorean theorem, the other leg is $\sqrt{(100 - 36)} = \sqrt{64} = 8$.

22 **56** **Area**

The area of a triangle is half the base times the height: (1/2)(16)(7) = 56.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 2, Math, Module 2

Questions 1 to 11

1 **Choice A** **Exponential functions**

Tripling every 2 hours means the number of triplings is t/2, so the population is 500 times 3 to the power t/2.

2 **Choice C** **Quadratics**

The equation factors as $(x - 8)(x + 1) = 0$, so $x = 8$ or $x = -1$.

3 **Choice D** **Percentages**

80% of 300 is 0.8 times 300, which is 240.

4 **Choice B** **Volume**

The volume is $\pi r^2 h = \pi(9)(7) = 63\pi$.

5 **Choice C** **Functions**

$f(4) = 3(16) - 24 + 5 = 48 - 24 + 5 = 29$.

6 **Choice A** **Statistics**

The first 6 scores total 480, and adding 94 gives 574. Divided by 7, the mean is 82.

7 **Choice D** **Probability**

37 students travel that way and 25 of them are in Grade 10, so the probability is 25/37. The fraction with 99 on the bottom uses every student.

8 **Choice B** **Surface area**

Each cube has 6 faces, and gluing two faces together hides 2 of the 12, leaving 10 faces of area s^2. So $10s^2 = 640$, $s^2 = 64$, and $s = 8$.

9 **Choice A** **Circles**

Arc length is the radius times the central angle in radians: $9 \times \pi/6 = 9/6\pi$.

10 **Choice B** **Equivalent expressions**

The numerator factors as $(x - 7)(x - 5)$. Cancelling $x - 7$ leaves $x - 5$.

11 **Choice D** **Trigonometry**

A right triangle with opposite side 3 and hypotenuse 5 has adjacent side 4, so tan A = opposite/adjacent = 3/4.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 2, Math, Module 2

Questions 12 to 22

12 **Choice C** **Exponential equations**

Write 4 as 2^2, so the right side is 2^(2x − 6). Equal bases give x + 4 = 2x − 6, so x = 10.

13 **Choice A** **Exponential functions**

A year is 12 months, so the value is multiplied by 0.9^(12/6) = 0.9^2 = 0.81 each year. That is a decrease of 1 − 0.81, or 19%.

14 **Choice B** **Linear functions in context**

The coefficient of x is the change in cost for each extra hour. The constant 45 is the fixed fee, and the 1 hour cost would be 48.5.

15 **Choice D** **Absolute value**

The inequality means x is within 3 of 6, so 3 ≤ x ≤ 9. That range has 7 integers, counting both ends.

16 **Choice C** **Ratios and rates**

The pumps fill 1/12 and 1/6 of the tank each hour, together 1/4 of it, so the time is 4 hours.

17 **10** **Linear equations**

Expanding gives 4x − 12 = 8x − 52. Collecting terms gives −4x = −40, so x = 10.

18 **8** **Circles in the plane**

Complete the square: $(x + 1)^2 + (y + 5)^2 = 38 + 1 + 25 = 64$. The radius is √64 = 8.

19 **154** **Quadratics**

The maximum is at t = −b/(2a) = 48/8 = 6. Then h(6) = −4(36) + 288 + 10 = 154.

20 **15** **Percentages**

Let L be the litres of the 20% solution. Then 0.2L + 0.7(10) = 0.4(L + 10). Solving gives L = 15.

21 **14** **Quadratics**

Exactly one real solution means the discriminant is zero: b^2 − 4(49) = 0, so b^2 = 196 and b = 14 (taking the positive value).

22 **-3** **Systems with nonlinear equations**

Setting the expressions equal gives x^2 − 6x + (6 − k) = 0. One solution means the discriminant is 0: 36 − 4(6 − k) = 0, so k = −3.